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* Blue indicates PPT slide

* Brown indicates instructions to technician

INTRO: Acts 2:1-4 (NKJV) *“When the Day of Pentecost had fully come, they were all with one accord[a] in one place. 2 And suddenly there came a sound from heaven, as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled the whole house where they were sitting. 3 Then there appeared to them divided tongues, as of fire, and one sat upon each of them. 4 And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.”*

(Smart phone vs. dumb phone)

(Braden – Load Down)

(Steele – You can make a computer & phone do what no one else can)

Today I am going to be talking to you about downloading a spiritual app that will enhance your walk with God. Acts 1:8

(NKJV) *“But you shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be witnesses to Me in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth.”*

(500,000,000 spirit filled Christians)

(Largest Christian group in the world)

(Some countries 25% speak in tongues)

(Africa Decade of Pentecost)

(American A/G less than 30% speak in tongues – American church in decline –

Because we have kicked out the very thing that causes us to be witnesses)

In order to fully understand the subject matter I want to attempt to answer the following questions:

- Is the baptism in the Holy Spirit for all believers? Acts 2:38-40 (NKJV) *"Then Peter said to them, "Repent, and let every one of you be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins; and you shall receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.*³⁹ *"For the promise is to you and to your children, and to all who are afar off, as many as the Lord our God will call."*
- Does a believer receive the Holy Spirit at conversion? Acts 19:1-7 (NKJV) *"And it happened, while Apollos was at Corinth, that Paul, having passed through the upper regions, came to Ephesus. And finding some disciples² he said to them, "Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?" So they said to him, "We have not so much as heard whether there is a Holy Spirit."*³ *And he said to them, "Into what then were you baptized?" So they said, "Into John's baptism."*⁴ *Then*

Paul said, "John indeed baptized with a baptism of repentance, saying to the people that they should believe on Him who would come after him, that is, on Christ Jesus."5 When they heard this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.6 And when Paul had laid hands on them, the Holy Spirit came upon them, and they spoke with tongues and prophesied.7 Now the men were about twelve in all." All believers

receive the seal of the Holy Spirit at conversion. The baptism in the Holy Spirit is a second work of grace, subsequent to the work of salvation.

- To receive the Holy Spirit, is it necessary to speak in tongues? To adequately answer this question, I want us to look at each time groups of people or individuals received the Holy Spirit in the book of Acts:

1) Upper Room - *Acts 2:1-4 (KJV)*

"And when the day of Pentecost

was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place. 2 And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. 3 And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them. 4 And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance." We must

conclude that in this initial outpouring, each of the 120 did in fact speak in tongues.

- 2) Peter and John at Samaria - Acts 8:14-18 (KJV) *"Now when the apostles which were at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent unto them Peter and John: 15 Who, when they were come down,*

prayed for them, that they might receive the Holy Ghost: 16 (For as yet he was fallen upon none of them: only they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.) 17 Then laid they their hands on them, and they received the Holy Ghost. 18 And when Simon saw that through laying on of the apostles' hands the Holy Ghost was given, he offered them money." This Scripture does not say that they spoke in tongues, but there was some kind of visible sign of the outpouring of the Spirit, because even Simon recognized what had happened.

- 3) Saul/Paul receives the Holy Spirit - Acts 9:17-18 (KJV) "*And Ananias went his way, and entered into the house; and putting his hands on him said, Brother Saul, the Lord, even Jesus, that appeared unto*

thee in the way as thou camest, hath sent me, that thou mightest receive thy sight, and be filled with the Holy Ghost. 18 And immediately there fell from his eyes as it had been scales: and he received sight forthwith, and arose, and was baptized." This outpouring of the Spirit upon Saul, who would later become Paul, does not reference the fact that he spoke in tongues, but listen to what Paul says at a later time. 1 Corinthians 14:18 (NKJV) *"I thank my God I speak with tongues more than you all."*

- 4) Peter preaching at the house of Cornelius - Acts 10:44-46 (NKJV) *"While Peter was still speaking these words, the Holy Spirit fell upon all those who heard the word.45 And those of the circumcision who believed were*

astonished, as many as came with Peter, because the gift of the Holy Spirit had been poured out on the Gentiles also.⁴⁶ For they heard them speak with tongues and magnify God." The Scripture specifically say's they did speak in tongues when they were filled with the Spirit.

- 5) Paul at Ephesus - Acts 19:1-6
(NKJV) *"And it happened, while Apollos was at Corinth, that Paul, having passed through the upper regions, came to Ephesus. And finding some disciples ² he said to them, "Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?" So they said to him, "We have not so much as heard whether there is a Holy Spirit."³ And he said to them, "Into what then were you baptized?" So they said, "Into John's baptism."⁴ Then Paul*

said, “John indeed baptized with a baptism of repentance, saying to the people that they should believe on Him who would come after him, that is, on Christ Jesus.”⁵ When they heard this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.⁶ And when Paul had laid hands on them, the Holy Spirit came upon them, and they spoke with tongues and prophesied.”

This passage specifically say’s they spoke in tongues.

Each time the book of Acts refers to people being baptized in the Holy Spirit it either directly states that they spoke in tongues or there was some kind of outward manifestation of the inward work of the Spirit. I submit to you it was tongues!

NEWS FLASH: From Acts two to today, every single person who has ever been

baptized in the Holy Spirit has spoke in tongues immediately.

(An evidence Vs. The evidence - Delayed evidence)

(Mike at Malvern)

Why was tongues chosen as the initial physical evidence of Holy Spirit Baptism? The tongue is the most unruly member of the body. James 3:6-8 (NKJV) "And the tongue is a fire, a world of iniquity. The tongue is so set among our members that it defiles the whole body, and sets on fire the course of nature; and it is set on fire by hell.⁷ For every kind of beast and bird, of reptile and creature of the sea, is tamed and has been tamed by mankind.⁸ But no man can tame the tongue. It is an unruly evil, full of deadly poison."

Before we decide to write the Holy Spirit off as unimportant or insignificant we should

consider the words of Jesus as it relates to the importance of the Holy Spirit. [John 16:7 \(KJV\)](#) "*Nevertheless I tell you the truth; It is expedient for you that I go away: for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come unto you; but if I depart, I will send him unto you.*" In this Scripture, Jesus is stressing to His disciples the necessity of His departure. As long as He lived in a flesh and blood body He could only be in one place at a time. He is attempting to explain to them that the reason it was so necessary for Him to go to the Father was so that the Holy Spirit would come and live in each believer, thus empowering each believer to carry on the work of Christ in the world.

If Jesus thought it necessary to depart so that the Holy Spirit could indwell and empower believers, where do we get off promoting the Holy Spirit as optional equipment?

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